

Undergraduate Independent Study Contract

Student to Complete the Following

**All information in this section is required.*

Student Information

Student Name*: Tom Alston USC ID*: S20730029

USC Email*: tpalston@email.sc.edu Major*: Classics

Course Information

Term*: ☒ Fall _____ Spring _____ Summer _____ Year*: 2026 Credit Hours*: 3

Subject Code*: GREK Course Number*: 399 CRN*: 15787

Instructor Name*: Dr. Mark Beck USC ID*: _____

Section Title*: Learning Ancient Greek Through Xenophon: Development of an Interactive Digital Curriculum

The section title will appear on the student's academic record. Character limit -100 characters, including spaces.

Additional Course Information:

This independent study consists of designing and implementing a web-based instructional platform for teaching Ancient Greek through the works of Xenophon. The project integrates traditional language instruction with modern educational technology, emphasizing incremental grammar instruction, vocabulary acquisition, authentic readings, audio pronunciation, accessibility, and cultural context. The resulting website will serve both as an educational resource and as a demonstration of effective digital pedagogy for Classical languages.

Course Summary:

The student will design, develop, and evaluate a comprehensive digital curriculum for beginning students of Ancient Greek centered on the writings of Xenophon. Lessons will combine graded readings, grammar instruction, vocabulary acquisition, pronunciation audio, interactive exercises, and cultural commentary. The project draws upon established pedagogical resources, including John Williams White's First Greek Book, while expanding instruction through additional works of Xenophon such as Memorabilia, Oeconomicus, Cyropaedia, and selected comparative passages from Plato. The study also investigates methods for improving accessibility and learner engagement through modern web technologies.

Objectives (What new skills and/or information will the student acquire?):

Upon successful completion of this independent study, the student will:

- Design a complete digital curriculum for introductory Ancient Greek.
- Develop original instructional materials based on Xenophon's writings.
- Apply principles of second-language pedagogy to Ancient Greek instruction.
- Integrate grammar, vocabulary, reading comprehension, and cultural content into coherent lessons.
- Implement interactive web technologies including pronunciation audio, progress tracking, vocabulary management, and assessment tools.
- Explore accessibility in online language instruction, including WCAG guidelines and screen-reader compatibility.
- Gain experience combining Classical scholarship with educational software development.

Textbooks, Readings, or Other Resources to be Used:

Xenophon: Anabasis, Memorabilia, Oeconomicus, and selected passages from Cyropaedia; selected passages from Plato; John Williams White, First Greek Book; Athenaze (for pedagogical comparison only); scholarly articles recommended by Dr. Mark Beck; current literature on second-language acquisition and digital language pedagogy; and Web Content Accessibility Guidelines (WCAG 2.1).

Method of Evaluation:

Evaluation will be based on successful completion of the web-based instructional project and supporting documentation, including: development of a functional instructional website; completion of multiple instructional modules and lessons; quality of Ancient Greek instructional materials; integration of grammar, vocabulary, exercises, and assessments; implementation of accessibility and usability features; periodic meetings with the faculty supervisor; and a final presentation and demonstration of the completed project, including discussion of pedagogical design decisions and future development.



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Certify whether this Independent Study will be used as part of your major, minor, or cognate:

☒ It WILL be used as part of my major, minor, or cognate. (This grade will be computed in the student's GPA).

Major ☒ Minor _____ Cognate _____

_____ It WILL NOT be used as part of my major, minor, or cognate. I will receive a pass-fail grade. (Pass-fail grades do not affect your GPA.)

GPA*: _____ Grade Point Average of 2.5 or greater required to enroll in independent study courses. Dean should verify GPA before signing.

Only students who take an independent study as part of their major, minor, or cognate may receive grade point credit for independent study. Independent study credits applied toward any undergraduate degree may account for no more than 10% of the total credit hours for that degree. The total amount of independent study credit per term is limited to six hours.

Approval Signatures

I understand that completion of this form does not constitute registration, and that I must register for this course in the usual manner. Student is to submit completed copy to the Office of the University Registrar to complete registration.

Student Signature: Tom Alston

Date: 08/05/2026

Instructor Signature: _____

Date: _____

Instructor to Complete:

_____ Yes, this student is conducting undergraduate research, an academic effort intentionally aimed at developing the student's skills in inquiry and opportunities to contribute to and/or pursue original intellectual, scientific, or creative work.

_____ No

Advisor Signature: _____

Date: _____

Department Chair/Area of Course Head Signature: _____

Date: _____

Academic Dean Signature: _____

Date: _____

